
1653–1706, GERMAN

One of the leading German musicians of his time, Johann Pachelbel was distinguished as an organist and teacher as well as a composer. He was born and died in Nuremberg, but he also worked in a number of other places in Germany and Austria, including Erfurt, Stuttgart, and Vienna, and his reputation as an organist was such that he was offered—but declined—a post in Oxford. In addition to his notable organ compositions, Pachelbel's large output includes chamber music, pieces for harpsichord, and vocal works of various kinds. Following his death in 1706, he was little known except to musical scholars, and he did not achieve widespread fame until the 1970s, when his serene but joyous Canon in D major became a surprise hit, being recorded again and again, featuring as background music in film and television, and inspiring adaptations in pop music.

KEY WORKS: Canon and Gigue for 3 Violins and Basso Continuo (Canon in D major), c. 1680–1690; *Musicalische Ergötzung* (Musical Delight [collection of chamber music]), c. 1691; *Hexachordum Apollinis* (Six Strings of Apollo [arias for organ or harpsichord]), 1699

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